

Harsath Kaliappa Gounder Thangavel

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Education

York University

Bachelor of Science (BSc) in Computer Science (Honours)

Toronto, Canada

January 2020 – December 2024

Professional Experience

Software Developer

Privex Inc.

October 2023 – January 2024

United Kingdom (Remote)

- Developed an AI-driven support assistant using Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) on a self-hosted LLM, delivering personalized responses to 800+ customers about support tickets, products, and services.
- Reduced support staff workload by 80% while providing instantaneous, context-aware assistance that improved overall customer experience.
- Implemented REST APIs to interface with the LLM and a Redis-based asynchronous task queue for processing customer queries and staff updates via Discord, prioritizing high throughput and robustness under heavy load.
- Designed data ingestion workflows across multiple channels, including support tickets, website documentation, and Discord announcements.
- Built the infrastructure using MySQL for chunked data storage and ChromaDB for embeddings.
- Tech Stack:** Python (Flask, Chroma, Celery, Langchain), Redis, MySQL, Docker, Linux

Machine Learning Engineer

CogniPet AG

April 2019 – December 2019

Switzerland (Remote)

- Developed Pet Breed Detection system using Xception neural network and transfer learning, achieving 94% accuracy across 120 dog breeds.
- Implemented REST APIs for model inference and integrated them into CogniPet's Android and iOS apps using AWS EC2.
- Built data management workflows for user-uploaded pet images in AWS S3 with GDPR compliance.
- Explored video-based techniques for pet facial recognition through multi-frame feature extraction analysis.
- Tech Stack:** Python (Flask, TensorFlow, NumPy), AWS (EC2, S3)

Machine Learning Consultant

Gnanamani Ventures Pvt. Ltd.

May 2019 – August 2019

Namakkal, Tamil Nadu, India

- Researched and developed a facial recognition-based attendance system implementing FaceNet architecture on NVIDIA Jetson Nano, optimizing for edge computing performance.
- Developed data pipelines to pre-process and fine-tune video data of 30+ staff members at Gnanamani College of Technology, resulting in a successful MVP that automated attendance tracking.

Founder and Developer

TaffyHub.com

August 2017 – July 2019

Coimbatore, Tamil Nadu, India

- Developed and launched school social networking platform, reaching 500+ registered users and 80+ daily active users.
- Implemented news feed, friend recommender, meme generation, engagement system, and premium membership features.
- Built backend with PHP (with memcached) and MySQL, frontend with JavaScript, jQuery, and Bootstrap.
- Self-hosted the platform on Linux infrastructure, implementing reverse proxies, automated backups (rsync + cron), and system maintenance as part of DevOps workflow.
- Generated \$80/month revenue through AdSense and premium memberships.
- Tech Stack:** PHP, JavaScript, MySQL, Memcached, Linux

Projects

Jix Interpreter | C, CMake, GitHub Actions

- Developed an interpreter for a dynamically typed programming language in C.
- Implemented fault-tolerant parsing and error handling, arrays, function pointers, loops, nested blocks, recursion, built-in functions, conditional statements, and control flow statements.
- Implemented basic functional programming support, including first-class and higher-order functions.

Prism Coverage | Java, Maven, JUnit, GitHub Actions

- Developed a Java test code coverage engine to measure test suite coverage against control flow and data-flow criteria.
- Implemented color-coded HTML report generation highlighting covered and uncovered sections of source code.
- Built JUnit test suite and GitHub Actions CI/CD workflow to verify coverage engine functionality.

Technical Skills

Languages:

Python, Java, JavaScript (ES6), TypeScript, C++ (C++17), C, Bash, HTML5/CSS3

Technologies:

Linux, Docker, SQL (MySQL, Postgres), NoSQL (MongoDB, Redis, Neo4j), AWS

Frameworks:

Node.js, React, Flask, Django, LangChain

Tools:

Git, CI/CD (Github Actions, Jenkins), Build tools (CMake, Maven, Vite)